investments, and leadership at regional organizations. It also involves India connecting further—whether diplomatically, economically, or strategically—with Southeast Asia. To maintain the balance of power in the region, India must improve its partnerships with the United States, Japan, and Australia: the Quad. It must also explore other Indo–Pacific partnerships, as with South Korea, Taiwan, and Europe, while striving to preserve its strategic relationship with Russia. Finally, India can try to find ways to manage its ties with China, while remaining mindful of structural competition. For India, preserving a favourable balance of power in the Indo–Pacific is critical to maintaining a global balance of power.

Major developments are also underway in India's west, including generational leadership transitions, a post-'Arab Spring' environment, the Taliban's takeover of Afghanistan, and Pakistan's political and economic woes. These developments, as described in Chapter 9: Think West, present opportunities for India to try to compel Pakistan to abandon its policy of using terrorist proxies against India. This will require making use of positive and negative incentives. India must also try to continue engaging Afghanistan to ensure favourable outcomes to its north-west. More ambitiously, New Delhi will have to work with a variety of partners to reshape West Asia (the Middle East) and connect further with Europe, while remaining mindful of its diversity of regional partnerships (including with the Gulf Cooperation Council, Israel, and Iran) and interests (including energy, the diaspora, security, investment, trade, connectivity, and technology).

Finally, Chapter 10: A Leading Power describes the erosion and growing ineffectiveness of global governance structures and institutions. International institutions are important for managing matters of war and peace, governing the global commons, and facilitating economic exchange and development. But a combination of vested interests among the established powers and revisionism among certain rising powers is making these institutions less effective. As a reformist power, India can work to try to revitalize multilateral organizations (including by making them more representative), build new issue-specific international coalitions, and reach